

SJAA Ephemeris Bulletin

March 2025

March Moon-ness

Welcome to another edition of the SJAA Ephemeris *Bulletin*. This month, Joe Fragola shares a couple of well-positioned targets for your next stargazing session. Get lost in an open cluster, and test your highest power eyepieces with NGC 2438. "Target of the Month" will continue to spotlight well-positioned targets for your enjoyment throughout the year.

Competing for your starry eyes this month is none other than our beloved Moon. In the late night hours on March 13th, the Moon will undergo a total lunar eclipse. Unlike solar eclipses, the totality of a lunar eclipse lasts for hours. Despite the hour, it's worth the bleary eyes to see the Moon in its reddened, eclipsed state, and take in the full-moon views without the full-moon brightness.

And of course we have the quarterly Ephemeris newsletter releasing this month. Don't miss it!

Carl Svensson
Vice-President
Ephemeris Editor

Target of the Month Messier 46 and NGC 2438

Constellation

Puppis, the Stern

Object Type

Open cluster, planetary nebula

Magnitude

6.0 (M46), 11.5 (NGC 2438)

Distance

5,400 light years

Diameter

30 light years

Age

300 million years

M46 was discovered by Charles Messier in 1771. There are an estimated 500 stars in this open cluster. The planetary nebula NGC 2438 is in the same field of view as M46, and was discovered by William Herschel on March 19, 1786. The planetary nebula is 3,300 light years from Earth, which makes it closer to us than M46 which is 5,400 light years away. NGC 2438 is not part of the star cluster, based on the fact that the two are moving at different speeds and different directions. The central star is an 18th magnitude white dwarf.

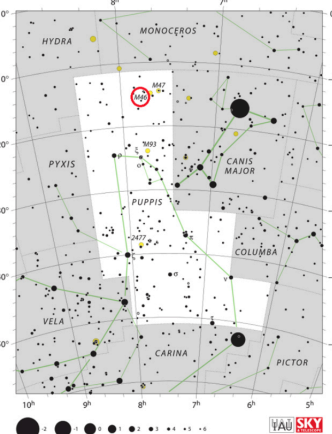


Image captured on 21 February 2025 at Houge Park In-Town Star Party.

Unistellar eQuinox; 54 minutes collection time

Volunteer Opportunities

There are many volunteer opportunities in SJAA! While we love having seasoned experts in our volunteer ranks, we happily welcome enthusiastic beginners, too. Please do not hesitate to reach out to the volunteer coordinator (volunteerchair@sjaa.net) to inquire about opportunities. Below are a few examples of programs that could use help:

School Star Party (SSP) Educating the public about astronomy and related sciences is our mission at SJAA. One of the most effective ways we do this is by hosting star parties for students! Come join the ranks of friendly and knowledgeable volunteers, and share the wonders of the cosmos with elementary through high school aged kids. Send an email to ssp@sjaa.net to get started.

Ephemeris Want to help produce the official publication of the SJAA? A volunteer here would help with finding and creating original content that showcases the club's activities, and relevant events in the astro community. Play reporter by attending SJAA events, and writing about them in our quarterly newsletter! Send a message to ephemeris@sjaa.net to get started.

Announcements

The SJAA Swap Meet is on March 16th, 9:00AM
SJAA's Swap Meet is a perfect opportunity for you to go through your astro closet, find the things taking up space that you don't use anymore, and make them available to others who may want or need them. It's also a great chance to find some interesting stuff, learn a lot, and mingle with other like-minded folks. Visit <https://www.sjaa.net/events/swap-meet/> for more information.

The Hands-On Imaging program leader position is still open. The Hands-On Imaging program offers two types of events: Public Workshops and Astrophotography Field Clinics. The Public Workshops offer members of the public the chance to learn the basic mechanics of astrophotography. The Astrophotography Field Clinic is a members-only event, held once a quarter, where imagers can bring their rig to a dark(ish) sky site, and get personalized help with any questions or issues they might have. Please contact volunteer-chair@sjaa.net if you have relevant experience and interest.



SJAA March 2025

Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
						1 Mendoza Ranch Observing 5:30 PM Mercury 0.4° N of Moon  5.0%
2 Solar Sunday (Cancelled) 2:00 PM  11.8%	3  20.9%	4  31.6%	5  43.1%	6 First Quarter Moon 8:33 AM  54.7%	7 Astro 101: Telescope Primer 7:00 PM John Herschel Born (1792)  65.8%	8 Mercury at Greatest Eastern Elongation  75.8%
9 Daylight Savings Begins  84.4%	10  91.3%	11  96.2%	12  96.2%	13 Total Lunar Eclipse 10:09 PM  99.1%	14 Full Moon Albert Einstein Born (1879)  100.0%	15 Board Meeting 6:00 PM Guest Speaker 8:00 PM  98.9%
16 Swap Meet 9:00 AM  96.0%	17  91.3%	18 Imaging SIG Meeting 7:30 PM  85.1%	19  77.5%	20 Vernal Equinox 2:01 AM  68.8%	21 Astro 101 Talk 6:45 PM In-Town Star Party 8:15 PM  59.2%	22 Starry Nights 8:30 PM  48.9%
23  38.4%	24  28.1%	25  18.5%	26  10.3%	27  4.1%	28  0.6%	29 Mendoza Ranch Observing 7:00 PM Partial Solar Eclipse (Europe)  0.3% New Moon
30  3.2%	31  9.1%		Times and dates are subject to change. Please check sjaa.net and www.meetup.com/sj-astronomy for the latest updates.			

Dark Sky Window